

Nintendo console, called the Nintendo Game and Watch. Nintendo was started in 1889 with Fusajiro Yamauchi manufacturing 'Hanafuda' playing cards. By 1963 they were Nintendo Co. Ltd, and were also manufacturing games. They entered the console industry in 1980 and became the Nintendo we're all familiar with today. Although not wildly successful, the Game and Watch also gets credit for debuting games like Super Mario Bros and Donkey Kong Jr.

1982 saw the release of the Colecovision as well as the Atari 5200. Right from the beginning, these were direct competition with each other, but Colecovision emerged the winner. This was due in no small part to the fact that with an add-on module, one could play Atari 2600 games on it. It sold in excess of 6 million units.

Even though more advanced, the Atari 5200 was less commercially successful due to a number of reasons. It was basically a redesigned version of the 2600, but it couldn't play games written for the 2600, which was still popular at the time. Secondly, the analogue controller was not self-centring, which made it unreliable and not at all user-friendly.

Early 1986, saw the birth of Nintendo, the console giant. They had released the Famicom (Family Computer) in Japan in 1983, selling more than three million units and more than 15 million games. They decided to launch it in the American market as well, and turned to Atari to help launch it. Atari were not too keen, so Nintendo went ahead and launched it by themselves. It was renamed the Nintendo Entertainment System (NES) and marketed as a home entertainment device. It featured classic, ever-popular Nintendo games such as *Super Mario Bros*, and was a huge success.

Credit must go to Nintendo for ensuring that high quality standards were met for their games. They had a strict third-party policy, which meant that no game could be released for the console unless they approved it. All this only ensured that their customers got the best games, and were happy with the console.